Decent Coaching Classes

VIII SB

Academic Conquest - VIII

ANSWER KEY

Subject: History (Ch. 2, 3 & 4) **Marks: 30**

Q.1 (A) Correct options **4**

(1) (b) Buxar

(2) (c) Robert Clive

(3) (c) Thane

(4) (a) Lord Canning

[1 mark each]

Q.1 (B) Table **4**

Person	Work / Contribution
Johannes Gutenberg	Discovered the printing press (c. 1450 AD), due to which new ideas and knowledge reached all sections of society.
Sir William Jones	Established the 'Asiatic Society of Bengal' in 1784
Rango Bapuji Gupte	Loyal officer of Chhatrapati Pratapsingh of Satara; fought the legal battle for him and went up to England, but without success.
Mangal Pandey	Shot an English officer at Barrackpore cantonment (against the greased cartridges); arrested and hanged.

[1 mark each]

Q.2 Concepts (any 2; 2 marks each) **4**

(1) Colonialism: A powerful country, on the basis of its economic and military strength, occupies another region, makes it a colony and exploits it by establishing its political supremacy. This tendency led to imperialism among the Europeans.

(2) Commercialisation of agriculture: The British encouraged farmers to grow profit-giving cash crops like cotton, indigo, tobacco and tea instead of food grains. This practice of stressing cash crops over food grains is called commercialisation of agriculture.

(3) Dual Government: Introduced by Robert Clive in 1765 in Bengal. The Company undertook the work of revenue collection, while the Nawab of Bengal had to maintain law and order. Taxes went into the pockets of Company officers, so its ill effects soon became visible.

Q.3 Reasons (any 2; 2 marks each) **4**

(1) Siraj-ud-Daulah was defeated at Plassey (1757) because Robert Clive had diplomatically bribed Mir Jafar, the Commander-in-Chief of the Nawab's army, promising to make him Nawab. Under Mir Jafar's leadership the army made no move to join the battle.

(2) The British charged huge taxes on Indian goods exported to England but very little tax on English goods imported to India. English goods were machine-made, with high production at low cost, so Indian artisans could not compete. Traditional industries closed down and many artisans became unemployed.

(3) Indian sepoys were ill-treated by the Company. Their salary and allowances were much lower than those of British soldiers, they could not rise above the post of Subhedar, and their allowances were gradually reduced. Hence the discontent (leading to revolts at Vellore in 1806 and Barrackpore in 1824).

Q.4 Brief answers (any 2; 3 marks each) **6**

(1) In 1453 AD the Ottoman Turks conquered Constantinople, the capital of the Byzantine Empire, through which the overland trade routes joining Asia and Europe passed. The Turks blocked this route. Hence the European countries needed alternative sea routes to reach Asia, which led to the geographical discoveries (Dias, Columbus, Vasco da Gama).

(2) Terms of the Subsidiary Alliance (any 3 points with explanation):

- The Indian ruler was assured of British military help.
- He had to maintain a British army in his court and pay cash or part of his territory for its maintenance.
- He could not make an alliance with, or declare war on, any other power without British intervention.
- He had to accept a British Resident in his state.

(3) Social causes of 1857: The Indians felt the British were interfering in their culture, traditions and customs. Acts such as the Sati Prohibition Act (1829) and the Widow Remarriage Act (1856) were correct from a social point of view, but Indians saw them as interference in their way of life and became dissatisfied.

Q.5 Detailed answers (any 2; 4 marks each) **8**

(1) Foundation of British rule in Bengal:

- Siraj-ud-Daulah became Nawab of Bengal in 1756. Company officers misused trade concessions and built fortifications around the Kolkata factory without the Nawab's permission, so the Nawab captured the factory.
- Battle of Plassey (1757): Robert Clive bribed Mir Jafar; the Nawab was defeated and Mir Jafar became Nawab.
- Mir Jafar later protested, so Mir Kasim was made Nawab; when Mir Kasim restricted the illegal trade, Mir Jafar was again made Nawab.
- Battle of Buxar (1764): Mir Kasim, Shuja-ud-Daulah (Nawab of Ayodhya) and Mughal Emperor Shah Alam were defeated. By the Treaty of Allahabad the Company got the right to collect revenue of Bengal.

(2) New administrative system under British rule:

- Civil Service: Lord Cornwallis introduced bureaucracy; districts were created with a District Collector as head (revenue, justice, law and order); officers were selected by competitive examination (ICS).
- Military and Police: the army protected British territories, acquired new territories and crushed revolts; the police maintained law and order.
- Judicial system: modelled on England; Civil and Criminal Courts in every district and a High Court for reconsideration.
- Equality before law: Indian Penal Code (committee under Lord Macaulay). Defects: separate courts and laws for Europeans, costly and slow cases.

(3) Consequences of the Struggle of 1857:

- End of Company rule: Government of India Act 1858 transferred rule to the British Crown; the Governor General became Viceroy (Lord Canning the first); the post of Secretary of State was created.
- Queen's Proclamation: no discrimination on race, religion, caste or birth place; services on merit; no interference in religion; treaties with princely states honoured and no further annexation.
- Army: proportion of British soldiers increased, artillery kept only with the British, military divided on the basis of caste.
- Change in policy: non-interference in social and religious matters, but 'Divide and Rule' to keep Indians from uniting; the struggle became an inspiration for the freedom movement.

[Any 4 valid points / 1 mark each. Any 2 of 3 questions to be attempted.]